

CAPES MONTHLY BRIEF

JULY 2026

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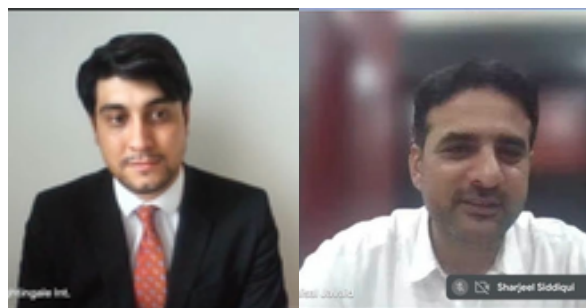
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ADVANCING INDEPENDENT
DISCOURSE ON ASIA-PACIFIC
& EURASIA



VISIT TO THE INDONESIAN EMBASSY

CAPES, as part of its 3rd Summer Internship Program, organised a visit to the Embassy of Indonesia in Pakistan. The delegation led by Dr. Khuram Iqbal, President CAPES, was warmly hosted by Mr. Rahmat Hindiarta Kusuma, Minister Counselor for Information and Cultural Affairs, who briefed the participants on Indonesia's culture, political system, and economy, along with insights into bilateral relations. The visit concluded with a guided tour of the embassy premises.



CAPES SIGNS MOU WITH NIGHTINGALE INT., KAZAKHSTAN

CAPES and Nightingale Int. Kazakhstan have signed an MOU to strengthen academic and policy collaboration on Eurasian and international affairs. The MoU was signed on behalf of CAPES by Dr. Faisal Javaid, Senior Vice President, while Mr. Eldaniz Gusseinov, Head of Research, signed on behalf of Nightingale Int.

PAKISTAN-RUSSIA INTERNATIONAL STUDENT RESEARCH CONFERENCE

CAPES jointly organised the Pakistan-Russia International Student Research Conference 2025-2026 with the Financial University and the Federal Urdu University of Arts, Science and Technology (FUUAST) as part of the Pakistan-Russia Academic Collaboration Initiative. The conference featured 9 research groups, representing more than 15 institutions, who showcased their research across diverse themes.



CAPES INTERNSHIP PROGRAM (ONSITE & REMOTE)



CAPES 3rd Summer Internship Program

CAPES launched its 3rd Summer Internship Program, welcoming a diverse group of students from universities across Pakistan, as well as participants from Southeast Asia. The cohort consists of 31 interns in total, including 14 on-site and 17 remote interns.



CAPES VISIT TO IPS

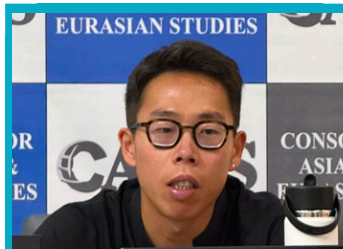
CAPES organized a visit to the Institute of Policy Studies (IPS). The delegation was warmly received at IPS. Mr. Khalid Rehman, Chairman IPS, interacted with the participants and spoke on fundamentals of public policy and role of think tanks in Pakistan. The session included an interactive Q&A session, followed by a tour of the IPS facility, including the IPS Press and Library.



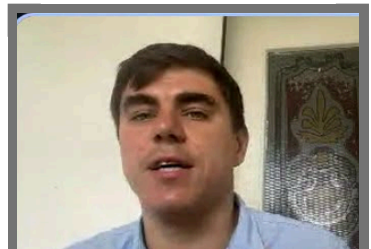
CAPES hosted an in-house discussion with Dr. Umair Pervez Khan, General Secretary, CAPES. He guided the interns on fundamentals of writing op-eds and shared practical insights on the publication process, including strategies for successfully pitching and publishing opinion pieces.



CAPES conducted an in-house discussion with Ahmad Saleem Rao, Lecturer at Air University. He instructed the interns on effective news monitoring, the preparation of concise news briefs, and the formulation of analytical assessments using the BLUF method.



CAPES held an in-house discussion with Michael Huang, PhD Scholar at University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, on Pathways to Higher Degree Research in American Universities. He guided the internship cohort on essentials of applying for scholarship opportunities.



CAPES held a Distinguished Lecture Series talk by Dr. Gleb Makarevich, Senior Research Fellow at IMEMO, Russia. Dr. Makarevich spoke on Russian perspective on contemporary developments in Asia-Pacific as well as in the Eurasian region.

Central Asia Security in the Post 9-11 era: Challenges for Russia

**CAPES SENIOR VICE PRESIDENT
DR. FAISAL JAVAID
WRITES FOR MODERN
HISTORY OF RUSSIA**

https://modernhistory.ru/f/begum_javid.pdf



"Central Asia (CA) lies between the Oxus River and the west of the Jaxartes River (Syr Darya). The people of this region are historically Muslim due to deep roots in Islam. It gave birth to great Muslim scholars who contributed to world civilization through their intellectual, scientific, and cultural achievements that raised the prestige and strength of this region. In the late 18th century, Russia had to divert its attention to this region due to the British expansion in the South Asian region and its ambitious designs towards Afghanistan."

Iran-US war: Who won the strategic communication battle?

**CAPES GENERAL SECRETARY
DR. UMAIR PERVEZ
WRITES FOR DAILY SABAH**

<https://www.dailysabah.com/opinion/op-ed/iran-us-war-who-won-the-strategic-communication-battle>



"Wars are fought on battlefields, but they are won and lost in the minds of audiences. The recent confrontation between Iran and the U.S. demonstrated that military superiority does not automatically translate into narrative dominance. While the U.S. possessed overwhelming military capabilities, Iran appeared to outperform Washington in the realm of strategic communication. The reason lies in a principle often overlooked by policymakers: the most important element of strategic communication is not messaging, media reach or technological sophistication, but credibility."

The Afghanistan Question

**CAPES DIRECTOR EURASIA
CHAPTER
DR. GUL-I-AYESHA BHATTI
WRITES FOR THE NATION**

<https://www.nation.com.pk/11-Jul-2026/afghanistan-question>



"For much of modern history, Eurasia has been viewed as a contested geopolitical space rather than a coherent strategic community. Great powers have competed across their vast landmasses, while regional states have often found themselves navigating rival alliances and external interventions. Today, Russia is advancing a different vision. Through its concept of the Greater Eurasian Partnership, Moscow seeks to replace fragmented geopolitical competition"

Canberra's Strategic Rise in Oceania

**CAPES RESEARCHER
YUSRA SARWAR,
WRITES FOR
MODERN DIPLOMACY**

<https://moderndiplomacy.eu/2026/07/19/canberra-strategic-rise-in-oceania/>



"The Asia Pacific's geopolitical balance is under change. While the U.S. remains the main architect of the plan, it is Australia that is becoming the executor of the strategy in the Oceania region. Through the signing of multiple defense agreements with the small island states, Canberra is transforming itself from a middle power to a regional security player in the South Pacific region. Australia, being the most trusted ally of the United States, makes it suitable to provide security to its neighbors."

Can Kabul hold?

**CAPES DIRECTOR EURASIA
CHAPTER
DR. GUL-I-AYESHA BHATTI
WRITES FOR THE DAWN**

<https://www.dawn.com/news/2018268>

DAWN

"The deceptive veneer of a monolithic and unyielding Taliban regime is rapidly giving way to profound structural decay, demonstrating that authoritarian societal suppression should not be conflated with institutional permanence or state capacity. Nearly five years after the fall of Kabul, the Taliban administration has reached a strategic impasse, balancing precariously on the precipice of a localised, multi-factional civil conflict."

The harder half

**CAPES NON-RESIDENT FELLOW
MUHAMMAD UMAR,
WRITES FOR THE NEWS**

<https://www.thenews.pk/print/1424076-the-harder-half>



"For the better part of three decades, the sale of Pakistan International Airlines (PIA) existed in the national imagination as something that could be announced but never carried out, a reform every government endorsed in principle and abandoned at the first sign of resistance. So, when a 75 per cent stake in the flag carrier passed to a consortium led by the Arif Habib group, it marked a break with the country's long habit of flinching."



PAK-PACIFIC BRIEF

- PM Shehbaz Sharif and Chinese Ambassador Jiang Zaidong reaffirmed the enduring Pakistan-China "iron brother" relationship.
- Ishaq Dar and Australia's Foreign Minister Penny Wong reaffirmed commitment to dialogue and regional stability.
- Ambassador Abdul Hameed met with JICA President Dr. Akihiko Tanaka in Tokyo to reaffirm the Pakistan-Japan development partnership.
- Pakistan High Commissioner Ahsan Raza hosted the Malaysian Defence Minister to discuss strengthening cooperation in defence.
- Mohammad Ishaq Dar met with the Secretary-General of ASEAN, Dr. Kao Kim Hourn, in Manila to review avenues for deepening engagement.
- Pakistan extends felicitations to the Solomon Islands on their 48th Independence Day.
- Pakistan's Trade & Investment Attaché met with Vietnamese entrepreneurs to boost trade.
- The first Pakistan-Japan Science and Technology Symposium was held in Tokyo to inaugurate a new phase of bilateral scientific collaboration.
- Ishaq Dar arrived in Manila to lead the Pakistani delegation at the 33rd ASEAN Regional Forum Ministerial Meeting.
- The Pakistan Pavilion was inaugurated at Japan IT Week 2026 with a focus on expanding IT exports.
- Pakistani community in Canberra hosts the Pakistan Mango and Multicultural Festival.



PAK-EURASIA BRIEF

- Pakistan and Belarus agreed to expand defence cooperation during a high-level meeting between their armed forces chiefs.
- Pakistan has offered Kazakhstan access to its ports for cargo transit.
- Kyrgyzstan and Pakistan discussed expanding bilateral economic cooperation, focusing on trade and investment.
- Pakistan hosted the 12th Meeting of the Heads of Border Services of the Competent Authorities of the SCO.
- President Zardari extended congratulations to Mongolian President Khurelsukh, and the people of Mongolia on their National Day.
- Pakistan and Russia agreed to pursue an MoU between their Interior Ministries to institutionalise cooperation on security.
- Kazakhstan has extended a US\$1 million grant to Pak Education Endowment Fund.
- Ishaq Dar led Pakistan's delegation to the SCO Council of Foreign Ministers meeting in Cholpon-Ata, Kyrgyzstan.
- Students from Islamabad Model College for Boys I-8/3 have arrived in Russia to participate in an educational program.
- Minister of State for Federal Education, Wajiha Qamar, met the Al-Farabi Kazakh National University Rector to enhance bilateral academic cooperation.
- President Asif Ali Zardari visited Kyrgyzstan, aiming to strengthen bilateral relations.
- IT Minister Shaza Khawaja met Kazakhstan's Minister of Digital Development, to discuss cooperation on digital transformation.